INTERFACE SYSTEM

TILT TO LIVE

A colder, quieter chrome so the arena is the brightest thing on screen.

V2 PROPOSAL · DARK ONLY

01
Red is the enemy. Only.
Hazard red never appears in chrome — no red badges, no red score, no red mode name. When the player sees red, something is trying to kill them.

02
Nothing in the UI glows.
Light is a gameplay signal, not decoration. Chrome uses flat fills and 1px hairlines; bloom is reserved for the ship, live weapons and threats.

03
One idea per line.
No item carries a badge, a tagline, a description and a status. Name, number, state — the player decides in under a second.

PALETTE

Void	Arena	Panel	Raised	Line
08090E	0D1016	141821	1B2029	262C38

Ion	Flare	Plasma	Locked in	Hazard
5B8CFF	FFB14D	A78BFA	3DDC97	arena only

CONTROLS

Play · Armory · Settings · 7,331 PTS · EQUIPPED

TYPE

Archivo 118
Display — wordmark, score, screen titles

IBM Plex Sans
Every label and sentence in the interface.
Body — 13 / 14 / 16

32,420 · 1.5× · 0/36
Mono — all numerals, tabular, never for prose

Retired: Unbounded, DM Mono body copy, emoji glyphs, every &-joined title.

AUDIT · 19 FINDINGS

Why it reads as generated

Ordered by how much each one costs the player. The first four are the tells people notice in the first three seconds.

01 **Everything glows at once** VISUAL

Cyan bloom sits on the title, the buttons, the mode cards, the badges, the HUD pills and the panel borders. When every element emits light, none of them are emphasis — and uniform neon-on-black is the single most recognisable machine-made look.

Flat fills, 1px hairlines, one accent. Bloom belongs to the ship, live weapons and threats.

02 **Threat red is also brand red** VISUAL

Enemies are red dots. So is the Code Red badge, the game-over score, the --blood token and the danger framing. The colour that means "you are about to die" is spent on decoration.

Quarantine #FF4757 to the arena. Code Red gets a mode colour that is not the enemy colour.

03 **Ampersand titles everywhere** COPY

"Armory & Upgrades", "The Armory & Vault", "Game Options & Settings", "Steering Sensitivity & Cursor Responsiveness", "Audio & Soundtrack", "Visuals & Accessibility". Pairing two nouns with an ampersand is the loudest generated-copy tic in the build.

One noun per screen: Armory. Settings. Handling. Audio.

04 **Every item explains itself three times** COPY

A mode card carries a badge, a tagline, a 25-word description, a multiplier and a "SELECT MODE" footer. A ship carries a name, a price and three lines of adjectives. A slider carries a title and two sentences of mechanism.

Name, number, state. Detail on hover or on the item page, never in the grid.

05 **The milestone rail never leaves** LAYOUT

A 240px panel covers the left fifth of the arena during play. In a game whose entire subject is reading incoming dots, a fifth of the field is permanently occluded by progress bars the player is not reading mid-run.

Collapse to a 4px edge rail in play; the full list belongs on the menu and the death screen.

06 **The HUD collides with itself** BUG

In the current build the score is overlapped by the multiplier pill, "Best 0" is clipped behind it, and a mode banner sits in the middle of the playfield over the spawn area.

Score top-left in one block, mode as a small pill, nothing painted over the arena centre.

07 **The armory tab bar overflows** BUG

"Controls & Spee..." is cut off at the panel edge on a 1280px viewport. Five tabs with icons and uppercase tracking do not fit the panel they live in.

Four short tabs: Weapons, Ships, Arena, Handling. Cursors and enemy skins fold into Arena.

08 **The vault number changes size with its value** BUG

A 2-point balance renders at roughly 60px in red inside a gold box; a 1,200-point balance renders small and gold. The same field looks like an alarm when the player has least.

Fixed 16px tabular mono, amber, always. Balance is information, not an event.

09 **Dying sends you shopping** FLOW

The death screen leads with flavour text, then the score, then stats, then earned points, then a glowing gold "Armory & Upgrades" button as the primary action. "Play again" is a grey ghost button below it.

Retry is the primary button and is focused by default. Space or Enter restarts.

10 **Milestones have four front doors** FLOW

Progress appears in the top stat bar, the left sidebar, a "Trophy Catalog" link, a "Milestone Trophies" menu button and the death screen. Five surfaces, one system, no single home.

One Milestones screen. The menu chip and the death screen deep-link into it.

11 **One currency, five names** COPY

"Vault", "PTS", "Milestone Points", "Points Earned", "Vault Balance" and the ◈ glyph all refer to the same number.

Call it Points everywhere. One glyph, one colour, one format.

12 **Mode names hide the difficulty** FLOW

Classic Survival, Code Red, The Gauntlet gives no ordering, and the multipliers (1.0×, 1.5×, 1.25×) do not sort either, so the middle card is the hardest and the right card is in between.

Order by multiplier, show it as the difficulty, and let the card colour carry the rest.

13 **Emoji standing in for an icon set** VISUAL

⚡ 🏆 ⚙️ 🎯 🎚️ alongside ◈ ★ ▶ ⚔. Mixed metaphors, platform-dependent rendering, and the universal signal that the icons were never drawn.

One 16px stroke set at 1.5px weight, or no icons at all.

14 **Mono type carrying paragraphs** VISUAL

DM Mono at 11–13px in muted grey sets the mode descriptions, the perk copy and the settings help text. Monospace is for numbers that must align, not for two-sentence explanations on a dark ground.

Plex Sans for prose, Plex Mono for numerals only.

15 **Dead status footers** LAYOUT

Every mode card ends with "SELECT MODE" or "● ACTIVE MODE" — a row of text restating what the border already says on a surface that is obviously clickable.

Delete the row. Selection is a border and a filled dot in the corner.

16 **The launch button says the thing twice** COPY

"ENTER THE ARENA" over "LAUNCH CLASSIC SURVIVAL", where the selected card already names the mode, two cards above.

The button says Play. That is the whole button.

17 **First run is a wall of zeroes** FLOW

Best 0 · 0/36 · 2 PTS across three chips, plus three empty milestone bars, before the player has done anything.

Hide the stat bar until there is a run to report; the rail shows the next milestone instead.

18 **Accessibility filed under Visuals** FLOW

High-contrast dot halo, the tether line and screen shake are the settings that decide whether the game is playable, and they sit under a heading about visual flourish, below audio.

Own section, top of Settings, above audio.

19 **Mobile controls are text buttons** LAYOUT

The in-game bar uses "Sound on", "II" and "Home" as small text targets. "II" is not a legible pause glyph and none of them reach a 44px touch target.

Two 44px icon buttons, pause and menu. Everything else lives in the pause sheet.

COPY PASS

Say less, land harder

Every string currently in the build, next to what it becomes. Roughly 1,100 words of interface copy down to under 300.

MENU

~~HYPER-NEON BULLET DODGE ARENA~~	**cut**
~~Weapons are your only salvation. Steer with WASD or mouse to survive relentless red dot swarms.~~	**Move to dodge. The guns fire themselves.**
~~SELECT GAME MODE~~	**cut — three cards are obviously the modes**
~~ENTER THE ARENA / LAUNCH CLASSIC SURVIVAL~~	**Play**
~~The Armory & Vault~~	**Armory**
~~Game Options~~	**Settings**
~~Milestone Trophies~~	**Milestones**
~~BEST SCORE 0 · MILESTONES 0/36 · VAULT 2 PTS~~	**hidden until the first run ends**

MODES

~~Classic Survival — The Definitive Arcade Arena — Dodge escalating swarms, detonate superweapons, chain multipliers, and survive as long as humanly possible.~~	**Standard — 1.0× — The full arsenal, ramping swarms.**
~~Code Red — Instant Hyper-Lethal Swarms — 2x initial swarm density, faster seeker dots, relentless arrow ambushes, and immediate circle encirclements. High risk, high multiplier.~~	**Code Red — 1.5× — Double density from the first second.**
~~The Gauntlet — Descending Maze & Survival Rush — Navigate descending wall barriers through moving gaps while evading normal enemy swarms. Walls push and block; speed accelerates as your survival score climbs!~~	**Gauntlet — 1.25× — Walls close in while you dodge.**
~~● ACTIVE MODE / SELECT MODE~~	**cut — the border says it**

DEATH SCREEN

~~Run terminated~~	**cut**
~~Swarmed by red dots~~	**moved under the score, small**
~~Dots Destroyed · Max Multiplier · Survival~~	**Kills · Best mult · Time**
~~POINTS EARNED +3,331 PTS / Vault: 7,331 PTS~~	**+3,331 pts → 7,331**
~~⚡ Armory & Upgrades (primary)~~	**demoted to a text link**
~~Play again (ghost)~~	**Retry — primary, focused, Space to fire**

ARMORY

~~TILT TO LIVE // THE VAULT — Armory & Upgrades~~	**Armory**
~~WEAPON PERKS · CURSORS · ENEMY SKINS · ARENA THEMES · CONTROLS & SPEED~~	**Weapons · Ships · Arena · Handling**
~~Singularity Blackhole~~	**Blackhole**
~~Spawn gravity wells that suck red dot swarms into event horizons and implode.~~	**Drags dots in, then collapses.**
~~Duration — +0.5s active pull per rank (up to +2.5s)~~	**Duration — +0.5s / rank**
~~Event Horizon Radius — +35px gravitational capture range per rank~~	**Radius — +35px / rank**
~~Gravitational Force — +20% pull acceleration towards center per rank~~	**Pull — +20% / rank**
~~★ Event Horizon Aegis (Invulnerability) — Your ship gains total invulnerability while inside the blackhole!~~	**Aegis — you are safe inside the well.**
~~★ Supernova Collapse — Vortex collapse produces a devastating 420px shockwave!~~	**Supernova — collapse fires a 420px shockwave.**
~~Rank 1 • ◈ 400~~	**400 pts · rank 1/5**
~~Piloting ✓~~	**Equipped**

SHIPS

~~Classic Arrow — The iconic high-agility white arrow craft with aerodynamic delta wings and dual cyan thrusters.~~	**Arrow — fast, fragile, free.**
~~Solar Aegis — Heavy reinforced warship chassis encased in polished 24K gold armor plates with radiant solar plasma flares.~~	**Aegis — heavy, wide hitbox, slow turn.**
~~Singularity Phantom — Stealth faceted voidcraft forged from cosmic obsidian with glowing violet edge runes and dark-matter core.~~	**Phantom — smallest hitbox.**
~~Cyber Matrix — High-tech digital vector starfighter with neon-magenta & cyan polygon brackets and electric grid exhaust.~~	**Matrix — faster weapon cooldowns.**

SETTINGS

~~Game Options & Settings / CONFIGURATION~~	**Settings**
~~Steering Sensitivity & Cursor Responsiveness~~	**Handling**
~~Fine-tune how your ship responds to your pointer. Adjust speed reaching maximum thrust and resting deadzone stability.~~	**cut**
~~Cursor Steering Responsiveness / Speed — Controls how aggressively the ship accelerates toward the cursor. Higher values reach top speed with shorter mouse displacement.~~	**Turn rate — higher turns sharper.**
~~Center Resting Deadzone — Radius around your mouse cursor where ship movement ceases. Prevents micro-jitter when hovering stationary.~~	**Deadzone — stops drift when you hold still.**
~~0.5x (Stable) ... 2.0x (Hyper)~~	**0.5× ... 2.0×**
~~WASD / Arrows + Mouse · Mouse Only · Keyboard (WASD / Arrows) · 🎮 Gyro / Tilt~~	**Mouse · Keys · Both · Tilt**
~~AUDIO & SOUNDTRACK / Synthwave Music~~	**Audio / Music**
~~VISUALS & ACCESSIBILITY / Targeting Tether Line / High-Contrast Dot Halo~~	**Readability / Aim line / Enemy outlines**
~~Screen Shake Impact~~	**Screen shake**
~~ENABLED / MUTED / DISABLED~~	**a switch**

PAUSE & INTRO

~~Paused — The swarm waits~~	**Paused**
~~Steer with WASD / Arrow Keys or Mouse~~	**shown once, on the first run only**
~~RED DOT FLEET INCOMING // SECTOR 01 — SPACE INVADERS DETECTED — TILT TO SURVIVE~~	**cut the whole cinematic; hold the wordmark for 600ms**
~~Space or Tap to Skip~~	**skippable by anything, unlabelled**

> **Three rules that produced all of the above**
>
> No title joins two nouns with an ampersand. No description restates what the number already says. Nothing in the interface uses a word the player would not use out loud — no salvation, no relentless, no definitive, no hyper-lethal.

TILT
TO LIVE

Move to dodge. The guns fire themselves.

Standard `1.0×`
The full arsenal, ramping swarms.

Gauntlet `1.25×`
Walls close in while you dodge.

Code Red `1.5×`
Double density from the first second.

▶ Play

Armory Milestones Settings

BEST	POINTS	MILESTONES
32,420	7,331	14/36

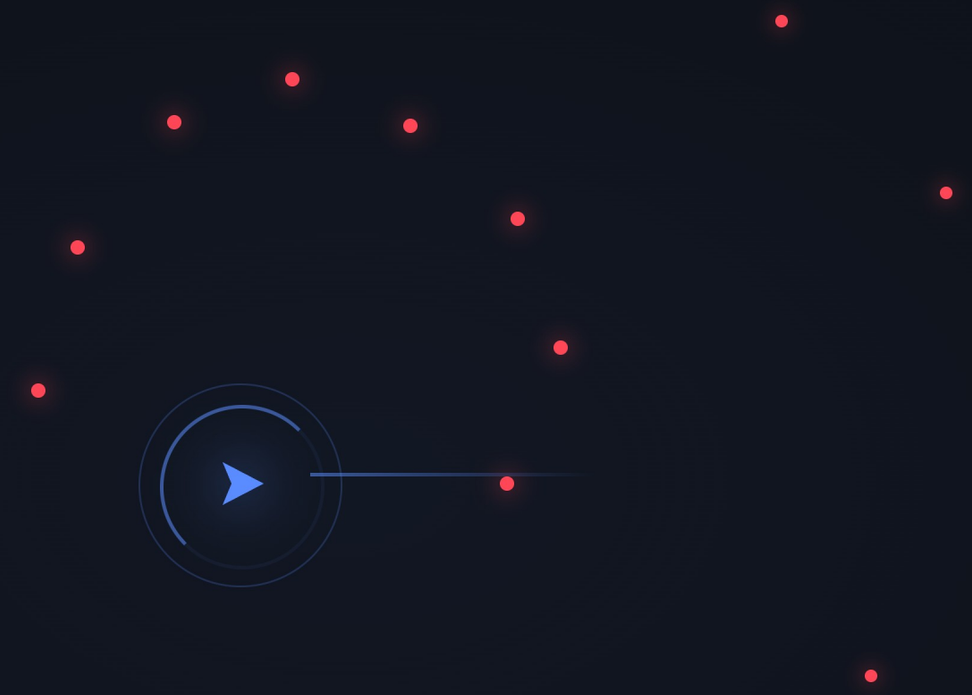


NEXT Neon Striker — 5,000 in a run

18,940

BEST 32,420 | STANDARD

7× CHAIN



Neon Striker +2

SHIELD 1.6S

BLACKHOLE E

32,420

Swarmed at 1:42 — Standard, 1.0×

☆ New best — up 4,110

89	12×	1:42
KILLS	BEST CHAIN	ALIVE

Points earned **+3,331 → 7,331**

- ✓ Neon Striker — 5,000 in a run +2
- ✓ Swarm Survivor — 10,000 in a run +3

Retry

Menu | Spend 7,331

SPACE to retry

Paused

18,940 · 1:04

Resume

Restart run

Quit to menu

Sound

Music

All settings

ESC to resume



TILT TO LIVE

Replaces the letterboxed cinematic — no SECTOR 01, no SPACE INVADERS DETECTED, no skip prompt.
600 ms hold, then straight into the arena. Any key or tap cuts it short.

Armory

Weapons | Ships | Arena | Handling

7,331 PTS

- Blackhole 3/5
- Missiles 5/5
- Laser 2/5
- Nuke 1/5
- Shockwave Locked

Blackhole

Drags dots in, then collapses.

INVESTED
2,400

Duration
+0.5s / rank
3/5
400 pts

Radius
+35px / rank
2/5
400 pts

Pull
+20% / rank
4/5
600 pts

ONE-OFF UNLOCKS

Aegis
You are safe inside the well.
2,500

Supernova
Collapse fires a 420px shockwave.
5,000

Armory

Weapons | **Ships** | Arena | Handling

7,331 PTS

HULL · 3 OF 6 UNLOCKED Hull changes hitbox size and turn rate. Nothing else.



Arrow — Balanced

HITBOX

TURN

Equipped



Viper — Aggressive

HITBOX

TURN

Equip



Phantom — Evasive

HITBOX

TURN

Equip



Aegis — Heavy

HITBOX

TURN

600 pts



Matrix — Fast cooldown

HITBOX

TURN

800 pts



Shuriken — Spin drift

HITBOX

TURN

1,000 pts

Armory

Weapons | Ships | Arena | **Handling**

7,331 PTS

Turn rate

1.0×

Higher turns sharper.

0.5× — 2.0×

Deadzone

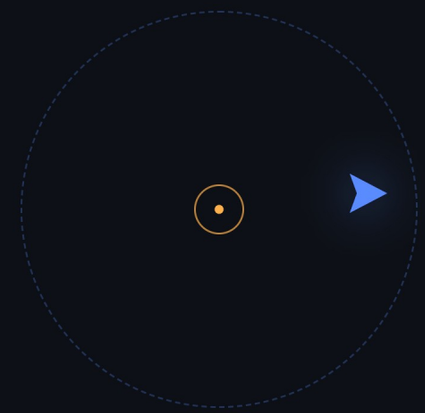
4px

Stops drift when you hold still.

0px — 16px

Reset

LIVE PREVIEW — MOVE THE CURSOR



deadzone top speed at

Settings

READABILITY

Decides whether the game is playable. Changed most, so it sits first.

Enemy outlines
Adds a white ring to every hostile dot.

Aim line
Draws the line from ship to cursor.

Background grid
Off by default — it competes with the dots.

Screen shake
Off | **Low** | Full

AUDIO

Sound

Music

CONTROLS

Mouse
point to steer

Keys
WASD / arrows

Both
whichever moves

Tilt
phone gyroscope

Turn rate and deadzone live in the Armory

DATA

Reset progress
Scores, points and unlocks. Cannot be undone.

Reset

Milestones 14/36

7,331 PTS

SCORE 5 of 9

- [x] **Rookie Dodger** — 1,000 in a run — +1
- [x] **Neon Striker** — 5,000 in a run — +2
- [ ] **Swarm Survivor** — 8,140 / 10,000 — +3
- [ ] **Void Walker** — 32,420 / 50,000 — +5
- [ ] **Century** — 32,420 / 100,000 — +8
- [ ] **Unbroken** — 0 / 250,000 — +12

COMBAT 6 of 14

- [x] **First Blood** — 10 kills — +1
- [x] **Chain Reaction** — 10× multiplier — +2
- [ ] **Overkill** — 89 / 500 kills in a run — +4
- [ ] **Perfect Vortex** — 12 / 40 dots in one well — +5
- [ ] **Untouched** — clear a minute without a shield — +6

MASTERY 3 of 13

- [x] **Gauntlet Runner** — finish a Gauntlet wall — +2
- [ ] **Code Red Veteran** — 3 / 10 Code Red runs — +6
- [ ] **Full Hangar** — 3 / 6 ships unlocked — +10

TILT TO LIVE

Move to dodge. The guns fire themselves.

Standard 1.0×
The full arsenal.

Gauntlet 1.25×
Walls close in.

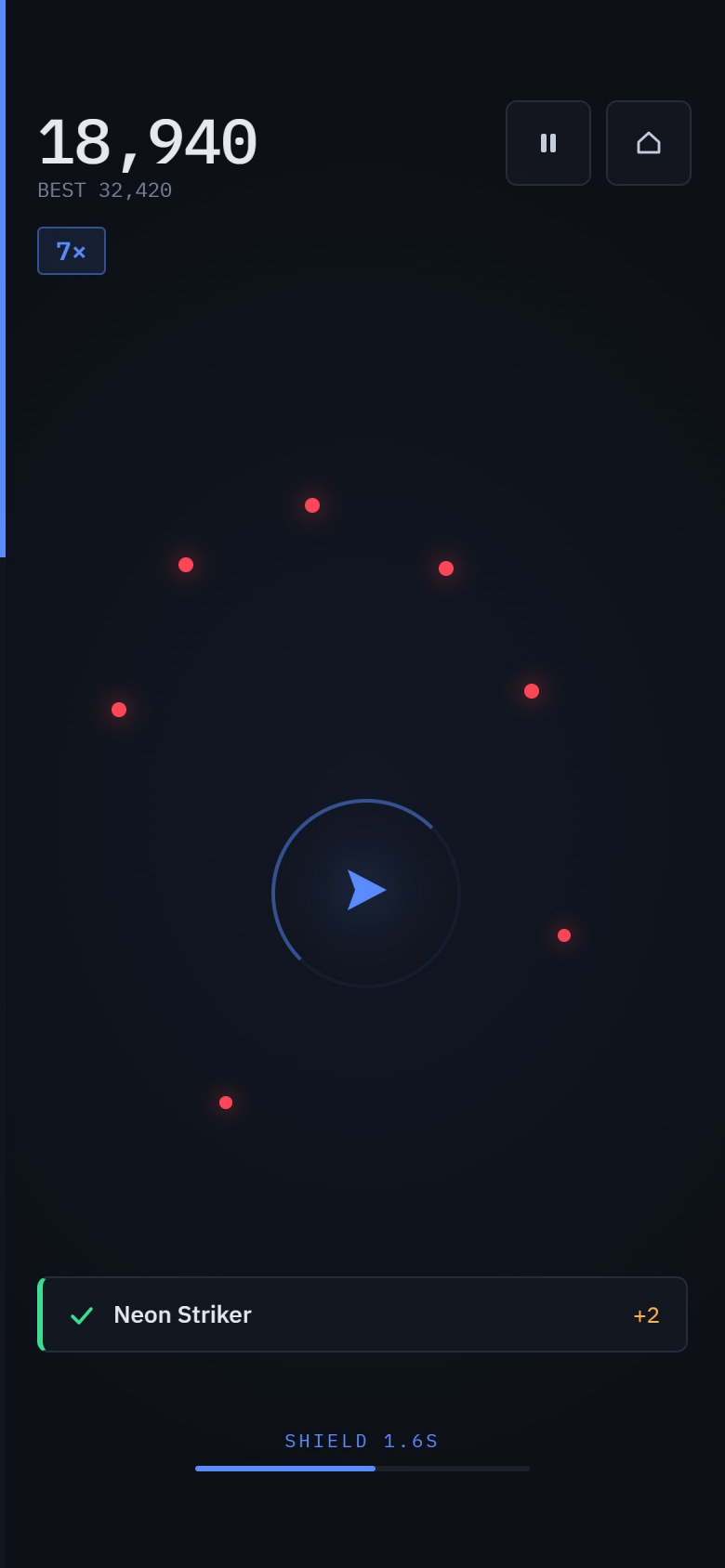
Code Red 1.5×
Double density.

Tilt to steer | Calibrate

Play

Armory | Milestones | ☼

BEST 32,420 | 7,331 PTS | 14/36


18,940
BEST 32,420
7×
Neon Striker
+2
SHIELD 1.6S

32,420

Swarmed at 1:42 — Standard

New best — up 4,110

89	12×	1:42
KILLS	CHAIN	ALIVE

Points earned +3,331 → 7,331

Retry

Menu

Spend 7,331

Armory

7,331

Weapons | Ships | Arena | Handling



Blackhole

Drags dots in, then collapses.

Duration +0.5s / rank

400

Radius +35px / rank

400

Pull +20% / rank

600

Aegis

You are safe inside the well.

2,500

Play